American Century Investments®

Emerging Markets Fund

Quarterly Commentary

Portfolio Review

Emerging markets (EM) equities challenged in the third quarter. After a strong first half, EM equities faced a more challenging environment in the third quarter. Higher interest rates on bonds, elevated energy prices and renewed geopolitical uncertainty dampened risk appetite, resulting in a modest decline for the benchmark, although the asset class remained among the better-performing areas of global equities.

Asia remains primary return driver. Regional performance was mixed, with Asia serving as the primary driver of returns as sustained investor enthusiasm for artificial intelligence (AI) and technology investment continued to support markets. AI-related semiconductor and hardware companies benefited from robust demand, although volatility increased as investors weighed valuations and the sustainability of spending trends.

Industrials was a source of weakness. Positioning in the industrials sector relative to the benchmark weighed on returns. Positions in Han's Laser Technology Industry Group and Contemporary Amperex Technology Co. were notable underperformers. The sector overweight relative to the benchmark also detracted from returns.

Information technology (IT) weighed on returns. Security selection within the IT sector detracted from relative returns. Zhongji Innolight, Montage Technology and Samsung Electronics were notable detractors during the quarter. AI-linked names declined during the third quarter as investors took profits following a powerful first-half rally and reassessed AI spending expectations.

Consumer staples helped returns. Security selection within the consumer staples sector contributed to returns during the quarter, with positions in Radico Khaitan and BIM Birlesik Magazalar outperforming despite what we believed was a challenging macro backdrop.

Key Contributors

China Construction Bank. China Construction Bank rose as it has benefited from improving investor confidence in Chinese financials and expectations that large state-owned banks would play a key role in supporting domestic economic stimulus initiatives.

Piraeus Bank. Piraeus Bank climbed as strong loan growth, earnings momentum and capital generation supported investor expectations for higher shareholder returns.

Novatek PJSC. Novatek advanced as we believe rising production and record shipments from a large liquefied natural gas project demonstrated improving utilization despite ongoing sanctions.

Key Detractors

SK Square. Shares of SK Square declined as weakness in its core SK Hynix holding hindered shares amid broader weakness in artificial intelligence (AI)-related stocks.

Han's Laser Technology Industry Group. Shares of Han's dropped as investors took profits following a strong first-half rally and became more cautious toward China's capital equipment names. However, we believe the company's core results remain robust, although investor concerns about its valuation and the durability of the manufacturing equipment upcycle have weighed on shares.

Goal and Strategy

Long-term capital growth by investing primarily in emerging market companies of all sizes.

Portfolio Management Team

	Start Date	
Name	Industry	Company
Patricia Ribeiro	1984	2006
Sherwin Soo, CFA	1995	2011

Top 10 Holdings (%)

Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co Ltd	15.33
Samsung Electronics Co Ltd	8.80
SK hynix Inc	4.36
Tencent Holdings Ltd	2.75
China Construction Bank Corp	2.21
SK Square Co Ltd	2.05
Alibaba Group Holding Ltd	2.03
Industrial & Commercial Bank of China Ltd	1.63
MediaTek Inc	1.58
OTP Bank Nyrt	1.42

As of 9/30/2026

The holdings listed should not be considered recommendations to purchase or sell a particular security. Equity holdings are grouped to include common shares, depository receipts, rights and warrants issued by the same company. Fund holdings subject to change.

Zhongji Innolight. Zhongji Innolight declined amid a broader correction in AI hardware stocks as investors questioned the sustainability of elevated AI infrastructure spending and valuations.

Notable Trades

MediaTek. We initiated a position in MediaTek, which is evolving from a smartphone chip supplier into a broader artificial intelligence (AI) and connectivity leader. MediaTek is benefiting from strong AI-related demand, expanding into AI PCs, automotive and custom AI silicon, and we believe it is well positioned to capitalize on the growing adoption of edge AI and AI infrastructure.

ASPEED Technology. We bought ASPEED, a leading provider of server management chips, as our research has indicated that rising AI server adoption has driven demand for its baseboard management controllers, supporting accelerating earnings growth through higher volumes, pricing and margins.

NAURA Technology Group. We exited NAURA as we believe lower-expected revenue from mature-node tools and elevated research and development investment has weighed on earnings estimates and the near-term profit outlook.

Ganfeng Lithium Group. We exited Ganfeng as recovering lithium prices have restored profitability. However, the prospect of supply restarts and continued industry capacity expansion eroded our confidence that improved market conditions would be sustained.

Portfolio Positioning

The portfolio continues to invest in companies where we believe financials are strong and improving but share price performance does not fully reflect these factors.

Artificial intelligence (AI) fuels earnings growth for many Asian firms. Companies in Taiwan and South Korea have benefited from significantly higher demand for semiconductors and memory, while firms in China and other countries have also participated in this trend. Beyond its strength in innovation, we believe the region offers widespread access to key minerals, low-cost energy and other essential inputs—not just for AI, but for the renewable energy industry as well.

Emerging markets (EM) are supported by a broad array of growth drivers, not just AI. EM-based energy companies have experienced higher demand since the closure of the Strait of Hormuz. We believe several firms in the financials sector look attractive, as do raw materials producers in Latin America and other regions.

Earnings trends, improving geopolitical outlook support EM equities. We believe EM companies have delivered meaningful earnings improvements while demonstrating resilience amid periods of market volatility. We think easing tensions in Iran could support a constructive outlook for future quarters. We believe strengthening operating results and improving corporate performance provide an attractive backdrop for stock selection.

Long-term growth drivers remain intact. We believe population growth, supportive government policies and rising domestic demand continue to provide structural support for many emerging economies. Combined with innovation-driven growth themes, these factors have reinforced our long-term outlook for EM.

Emerging Markets Fund

TICKERS Investor Class: TWMIX | I Class: AMKIX | A Class: AEMMX | C Class: ACECX | R Class: AEMRX | R5 Class: AEGMX | R6 Class: AEDMX

Data presented reflects past performance. Past performance is no guarantee of future results. Current performance may be higher or lower than the performance shown. To obtain performance data current to the most recent month end, please visit www.americancentury.com/performance. Investment return and share value will fluctuate, and redemption value may be more or less than original cost. Data assumes reinvestment of dividends and capital gains. Returns for periods less than one year are not annualized. For information about other share classes available, please consult the prospectus. There is no guarantee that the investment objectives will be met. Dividends and yields represent past performance and there is no guarantee that they will continue to be paid.

Average Annual Total Returns for Period Ended 9/30/2026

Class	Qtr (%)	1 Year (%)	3 Year (%)	5 Year (%)	10 Year (%)	Since Inception (%)	Inception Date	Gross Expense Ratio (%)
Investor	-7.12	33.00	26.87	6.96	8.48	6.96	9/30/97	1.26
I	-7.03	33.25	27.16	7.17	8.70	9.03	1/28/99	1.06
R5	-7.02	33.29	27.16	7.17	8.70	8.63	4/10/17	1.06
R6	-6.98	33.49	27.35	7.34	8.86	7.58	7/26/13	0.91
MSCI Emerging Markets Index	-0.37	29.22	24.09	8.94	9.09	-	-	-

Extraordinary performance is attributable in part to unusually favorable market conditions and may not be repeated or consistently achieved in the future.

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Historical performance for the R5 Class prior to its inception is based on the performance of I Class shares, which have the same expenses as the R5 Class.

Pre-inception differences in R5 Class and I Class performance are based on rounding.

Expense ratio is as of the fund's current prospectus. The I Class minimum investment amount is $5 million ($3 million for endowments and foundations) per fund. The R5 Share Class is available only to participants in group employer-sponsored retirement plans where a financial intermediary provides recordkeeping services to plan participants.

Periods greater than one year have been annualized.

You should consider the fund's investment objectives, risks, and charges and expenses carefully before you invest. The fund's prospectus or summary prospectus, which can be obtained at americancentury.com, contains this and other information about the fund, and should be read carefully before investing.

The opinions expressed are those of the portfolio investment team and are no guarantee of the future performance of any American Century Investments portfolio. Statements regarding specific holdings represent personal views and compensation has not been received in connection with such views. This information is for an educational purpose only and is not intended to serve as investment advice.

The information is not intended as a personalized recommendation or fiduciary advice and should not be relied upon for investment, accounting, legal or tax advice.

International investing involves special risk considerations, including economic and political conditions, inflation rates and currency fluctuations. Investing in emerging markets may accentuate these risks.

The MSCI Emerging Markets Index is a free float-adjusted market capitalization index that is designed to measure equity market performance of emerging markets. Source: MSCI. MSCI makes no express or implied warranties or representations and shall have no liability whatsoever with respect to any MSCI data contained herein. The MSCI data may not be further redistributed or used to create indices or financial products. This report is not approved or produced by MSCI.

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